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Light to the Nations: Term 3 2026
Written Test: Year 9 & 10
Chapter 5 Part I: Pages 115-124

1. a) When were the '**Dark Ages**'? 400 - 900

b) Why were they called the 'Dark Ages'?

They were thought to be a time with little learning.

2. During the Dark Ages there were 6 significant challenges. Give **any 4** of them.

- Warefare
- Destruction of Books
- Crop failure
- Travel difficulties
- Living Standards

3. C hristendom is the name given to the civilization that arose from the ancient civilizations of G reece, R ome and I sreal.

4. The greatest m igration of peoples in human history took place in the 4th through 6th centuries. ~~The Germanic peoples had been formerly spread across the f_____ of the B_____ Sea and the plains and river valleys of Eastern Europe~~.

5. From the Blue Box, what is a **demigod**?

A being who has more power than a human but less than a god.

6. For the Germans, the word 'law' meant 'age-old custom'. At first, laws were not written down, but were memorised and passed along by the bard or the council elders.

7. After eyewitnesses, what were the **3 types of 'evidence'** the accused could appeal to under Germanic law?

The oath, ordeal or trial by combat.

8. Name the **7 gods** after whom our 7 days of the week are named.

Sun, mon, tiu, Wooden, thor, friea, saturn

9. Germanic songs and poems celebrated courageous defeats as much and victories and successes. Even when they became Catholic, the Germans saw courage as the greatest virtues.

10. In 507, in fierce battles, the F anks drove the Visigoths from most of G aul. The Visigoths established their kingdom in the Roman province of H ispania, making T olito their royal capital, in the centre of the peninsula.

11. Monasteries were centres of learning in Visigothic Spain. Monks were editors, co pyists, li brarians, and sc hool te achers.

12. For two generations, the descendants of S everianus greatly influenced the Visigothic kingdom in Spain. The Church venerates 5 members of the family as saints.

13. a) Why did Leovigild try to force Arianism upon his Catholic subjects? And b) what proportion of his subjects were Catholics?

a) He wanted to unify his kingdom

b) 90%.

* 14. King Leovigild was married to G oswintha, whose 13-year old granddaughter named Ingunth was married to Leovigild's eldest son H ermenagild.

15. Provide any 2 facts about **Hermenegild's rebellion** against his father.

Converted to Catholisism

Declared independence from tolito

* 16. Briefly describe how Hermenegild died.

Martyred for refusing Communion from an Arian bishop

17. What happened on the 8th May, 589?

Public renounce of Arianism

18. The c ouncil of Toledo were to become one of the most important institutions of the Visigothic monarchy. They were a unique sign of the close c operation that developed between C hurch and S tate.

19. The bishops helped the Visigothic kingdom with 3 things: give any 2 of them.

Political Stability

Foriegn Affs

* 20. The book called 'E temoligise' was written by St. Isidore of Seville. It c ollected together all the l earning known in his time, and helped p reserve much of Greek and Roman wisdom and knowledge.

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Chapter 5 Part II: Pages 124-133

1. The Vandals crossed the Rhine river on the 31 of December in the year 406.

2. Why did the Vandals to make this crossing?
Not paid for guarding frontier.

3. a) Which 2 impediments held back Genseric from becoming King of the Vandals?
Crippled foot, Son of slave.

b) Which 2 redeeming features did he possess to overcome them?
great rhetoric, good warrior

4. From the Blue Box: a) What is a **garrison**?
troops in territory or base camp

b) What is a **menorah**?
7 branched candle holder

5. From the footnote, what is a **serf**?
Pesant legally bound to a land

6. Having become soft from luxury, the Vandals did not survive as a distinct nation, but were defeated by the Eastern Emperor Justinian in the year 533.

7. The Frankish kings all claimed decent from a mythic hero called Merrovich.

8. Give any 2 facts about **how the Franks fought** on the battlefield.
- W/o Armour.
- Speared

9. a) What did Clotilde say to her husband Clovis about his battle against the Alamanni tribe?
Rely on God

b) In brief, what did Clovis say in return?
Promised to convert on victory.

10. King Clovis had himself b aptised in the city of reims by Bishop remi on Christmas Day in the year 496. = ?

11. How did Clovis **get rid** of his last Meroving rival, the prince of Cologne?

Prince murder father, then murder prince

12. From the Blue Box, what is a **chancellor**?

Secratery of the King.

13. King Pepin the Short began a new line of Frankish kings called the C aralingins. They were named for Pepin's father, Charles M artel. Charles is K arl in Frankish and C arolos in Latin.

14. In the year 476 the Goth named O doassa deposed the boy king Romulus A ugustulus, proclaimed himself 'king of the Germans in Italy', and sent the imperial regalia to the Easter Emperor Z eno in Constantinople.

15. From the Blue Box, what are **regalia**?

Symbols of royalty

16. a) Theodoric was sent by his father to the city of Constantinople to study for 10 years.

b) Besides the education he would receive, why did his father send Theodoric away from his own people?

Hostage to guarentee father's agreement.

17. What are 2 improvements made by Theodoric when he became King of Italy?

- Repaired aquaducts.
- Restored public buildings.

18. Because the Ostrogoths were Arians, this meant there were different churches in the one kingdom and constant frictions between the Roman Italians and the Ostrogoths.

19. Theodoric was 'fitted to the task of mediating between the two cultures'. From the footnote, what is a **mediator**?

a person who helps 2 differents sides understand one another.

20. Toward the end of his life, Theodoric became afraid that the Eastern Roman Emperor Justin in Constantinople was plotting to kill him. Thus he condemned several senators to death because of anonymous letters that claimed they were plotting his death. Among the senators put to death was the philosopher named Bolithius.

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Chapter 6 Part I: Pages 139-150

1. What does it mean to **abdicate**?

Give up the right to rule

2. a) The Emperor Justinian reigned from the year 527 until 565

b) More than anything else, what did Justinian want to do as Emperor?

Reunite eastern and western under a Christian empire

3. Justinian brought 6 valuable assets to the throne. Give **any 2** of them

Organised, long work Hours, Great Physical Stamina

4. Justinian brought 6 valuable assets to the throne. Give **another 2** of them.

Taxe for the arts, Enspire Loyalty, His Wife.

5. The 'Nika Revolt' in the year 532 resulted in 30,000 people being slain by Belisarius and his Gothic mercenaries. The Greek word *Nika* means 'victory!' and resulted in the burning down of Hagia Sophia, a great cathedral built by Constantine some 200 years earlier.

6. Hagia Sophia (which is Greek for 'Holy Wisdom') was rebuilt in only 6 years. Worshipers were made to feel that they stood in the forecourt of Heaven.

7. Give any 4 facts about **mosaic** art.

Roman, perfected in east, tiny glass and stone, pasted on Concrete, made to reflect light, look as if floating.

8. Provide the 2 reasons why Justinian ordered a new summary of Roman Law.

He wanted to minimise corruption in court and make fair judgement more easily accessable

9. The 'Codex Justinianus' was published between the years 529 and 534.

* 10. From the Blue Box, what does the word **Byzantine** mean?

~~Norm~~ Civilisation that comes from the city of Byzantium where Constantinople was born.

11. How did the Emperor Justinian celebrate his 80th birthday?

A ~~week~~ of festivites of the re-opening of Hagia Sofia. week

12. From the Blue Box, what does **lay** mean?

any member of the church who is non-clergy

13. Strange as it may seem, it was those who sought nothing more than a life of prayer and the salvation of their souls who became the true preservers of civilized life and thought.

14. a) Born in the late 300 s, Patrick, the son of a Christian Deacon, was carried off to slavery in Ireland when he was not quite 16 years old.

b) Back in Britan, what words did Patrick hear in a vision?

"Holy youth came walk among us once again."

15. Because of which 2 deficiencies did Patrick devote himself to 14 years of study?

Not enough Bible memorised

He couldn't read

16. Preaching the Gospel to the Gaelic Irish was difficult because the Christian Gospel of forgiveness denied the heroic traditions on which their society depended.

17. a) From the Blue Box, what is a **clan**?

An extended family which is loyal to the clan cheif

b) From the Blue Box, what is a **Druid**?

A Druid is a galic preist who came from an aristocrasy Hereditary. Believed to be able to cast magic

18. Briefly describe what happened one Easter involving St. Patrick.

Light pascal candle, angered Druids, they reported him to the king

19. St. Patrick established his church at Armagh in the northern kingdom of Ulstar. Within 25 years, all of Ireland was at least nominally Catholic. Patrick lived and worked in Ireland for almost 60 years until his death.

20. Provide any 4 facts about the monks and monasteries of Ireland.

Monastries were centres of learning.

Monks replaced Druid's memorisation and learning.

Memorised whole Books.

- Left Ireland to Spread monastic life

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Catholic History: Term 4 2026

Written Test: Year 9 & 10

Chapter 6 Part II: Pages 150-162

1. Give any 4 facts about the family background and early life of **Boethius**.

- Family was Noble
- Aricci family
- Entered Senate at young age
- Theadoric apointed him in high office
- Translated Greek to latin texts.

2. List the **Seven Liberal Arts**.

Grammer, Logic, Rhetoric, Arithmatic, Geometry, Astronomy, Music

3. Give any 4 facts from the **backstory** of how Boethius found himself in prison awaiting death.

- King Theadoric was suspitious of a plot against Him.
- He was an Italian, Catholic Senator
- Tortured and questioned but he wouldn't confess

4. In his book 'The Consolation of Philosophy', Boethius did not use any arguments from Christian revelation but only those available to human reason.

5. a) According to Boethius, what is **happiness**?

Happiness is seeing God in all things

b) From the Blue Box, what is **Providence**?

God knowing before an event happening (fore-knowledge)

6. Give any 4 facts from the **backstory** of St. Benedict *before* founded Monte Cassino.

- Born 480 in Nursia
- Studied in Rome, disgusted by immorality.
- Sister's name is Scholastica

7. Briefly tell the story of **St. Benedict and his sister St. Scholastica** in the cave at Subiaco.

- Met once a year
- Asked Him to stay longer, he refuses
- She prays, Storm comes, he stays.

8. How did St. Benedict do things **differently** for his community compared to the Egyptian hermits?

- Communal prayer instead of alone. Self sufficient
- Benedict's rule on penance was less harsh.

9. The *Rule of St. Benedict* prescribes c~~onstant~~ omgn prayer 7 times a day, also commanding p hysical l abour as a balance to the monk's life of prayer and meditative reading.

10. What is the **Latin motto** of the Benedictine monastic life, meaning 'Pray and work!'?

Ora et Labora

11. Why did the **Benedictine monastic life** *appeal to more people* than the monasteries of the East, such as in Egypt?

Easier, more balanced life.

12. Provide any 4 facts about **Gregory the Great** *before* he became Pope.

- Made prefect of Rome
- Made mansion into Monastry
- Commanded armies
- Made Ambassidor
- Donated whole fortune

13. From the Blue Box, what does **cloistered** mean?

Closed off, from latin carrborae, to close

14. Give both the Latin *and* English of how Pope St. Gregory **signed** all his letters.

servant of the servant of God, Servus servorum Dei.

15. Pope St. Gregory tried to establish a uniform liturgy. What is a **uniform liturgy**?

Same basic prayers, ceremonies and customs used every where.

16. In your own words, what did Ethelbert's advisor say about **the bird flying through the hall**?

We don't know what is in the darkness outside the hall (after life) but Christianity has an explination so we should listen.

17. Describe the *difference* between the way **Gaelic** monks shaved their head compared with the **Benedictine** monks.

galiec had mullet, Benedictines had crown.

18. At the Synod of Whitby in 664, King ~~Oswald~~ Oswig of Northumbria called together bishops to decide whether the Church in Britain would follow Gaelic or Roman practices.

19. From the Blue Box, what is a **synod**?

Gathering of local clergy to discuss church matters.

20. Pope Gregory, even in his old age, worked 14 hours a day, wrote the P astoral R ule (a guidebook for bishops) as well as the D ialogues to encourage future monks to a life of holiness.